

Esercizi: Past simple e Past continuous

Link:

https://kiwi.app/notes/note_01m48jendefk49hj34d28k1qxs

Past Continuous vs. Simple Past

When to use Past Continuous

- Describes an action **in progress** at a specific moment in the past.

When to use Simple Past

- Describes a **completed action** or a series of actions.

Typical pattern:

Examples

- Dad **was washing** the car when his boss **called** him.
- Susan **was listening** to music when she **received** an SMS.
- We **were crossing** the road when the accident **happened**.

Forming Complete Sentences from Prompts

Guideline: Identify the two actions, decide which is ongoing (Past Continuous) and which is the interrupting event (Simple Past).

| Prompt | Completed Sentence | |-----|-----| | Sam and Meg / meet / while / study / Boston | *Sam and Meg **met** while they **were studying** in Boston.* | | what / the students / do / when / teacher / arrive / ? | *What **were the students doing** when the teacher **arrived**?* | | I / play / computer games / when / you / call | *I **was playing** computer games when you **called**.* | | when / we / arrive / restaurant / our friends / already eat | *When we **arrived** at the restaurant, our friends **had already eaten**.* | | David / hurt / leg / while / play / rugby | *David **hurt** his leg while he **was playing** rugby.* | | Betty / find / old photograph / her family / while / she / do / housework | *Betty **found** an old photograph of her family while she **was doing** housework.* | | Nick / walk / park / when / he / find / wallet | *Nick **was walking** in the park when he **found** a wallet.* | | I / surf / Internet / when / computer / stop working | *I **was surfing** the Internet when the computer **stopped** working.* | | who / you / see / while / you / do the shopping / ? | *Who **did you see** while you **were doing** the shopping?* | | it / not rain / when / we / leave / home / this morning | *It **was not raining** when we **left** home this morning.*

Translating Italian Sentences (Past Progressive)

Italian	English (Past Continuous)
Quando mi hai visto ieri stavo andando al cinema.	When you saw me yesterday, I was going to the cinema.
Linda si è tagliata mentre stava cucinando.	Linda cut herself while she was cooking.
Stavo navigando in Internet quando ho trovato un sito interessante.	I was surfing the Internet when I found an interesting site.
Mentre facevamo jogging al parco ha cominciato a nevicare.	While we were jogging in the park, it started snowing.
Nathan stava salendo sull'autobus quando il suo zainetto si è rotto.	Nathan was getting on the bus when his backpack broke.
Che cosa stavi leggendo quando eri in biblioteca?	What were you reading when you were in the library?
Quando mia madre è arrivata non stavo facendo i compiti: stavo ascoltando musica.	When my mother arrived, I was not doing homework; I was listening to music.
Sylvia ha fatto un incidente perché non stava guardando la strada.	Sylvia had an accident because she was not looking at the road.
Il sole splendeva quando siamo andati a fare una passeggiata.	The sun was shining when we went for a walk.
Stavi dormendo quando il ladro è entrato in casa?	Were you sleeping when the thief entered the house?

Present Perfect Simple vs. Simple Past

Core Differences

Aspect	Present Perfect Simple	Simple Past
Time reference	Unspecified time up to now; relevance to the present	Specific, finished time in the past
Signal words	yet, already, just, ever, never, since, for	yesterday, last week, in 1999, when
Structure	have/has + past participle	verb-ed (regular) or irregular past form

Using yet, already, just, still

Sentence	Correct adverb
A: Have you made your bed? B: No, I haven't made it yet.	
I'm happy. I've already found out I have been accepted by a university.	
A: Are you still writing that report? B: Yes, it's more complex than I thought.	
A: Would you like some fruit? B: No, thanks, I've already had a fruit salad.	
Why haven't you swept the floor yet?	
Burt! You still haven't paid the bill!!	
We've just called an ambulance.	

Choosing Simple Past or Present Perfect

- Present Perfect when the action has relevance to the present or when the exact time isn't
- Simple Past when a definite past time is given (e.g., last month, yesterday).

Examples

1. He **has already told** you why he won't be able to come. (*present perfect – relevance now*)
2. We **have visited** London. (*no specific time*)
3. I **gave** you his phone number last month. (*simple past – specific time*)
4. Why **haven't you called** him yet? (*present perfect – action expected up to now*)
5. **Have you seen** that new movie yet? (*present perfect – up to now*)
6. My grandma **sent** me a birthday present yesterday. (*simple past*)
7. We **heard** a great new song on the radio two days ago. (*simple past*)
8. We **have just got** home. (*present perfect – recent action*)
9. So far he **has only spoken** about the company's past successes. (*present perfect*)

Idioms

Idiom	Definition	Example
by the book	Doing things according to the rules	He does everything by the book.
on the ball	Being competent, alert	The team are on the ball.
on the same page	Thinking in a similar way	We are on the same page about the project.
in no time	Very quickly	The meeting was over in no time.
make good	To succeed	They make good in everything they try.
from the ground up	Starting from the beginning	He built his company from the ground up.
get the ball rolling	To start something	I need to get the ball rolling on the presentation.
think outside the box	To think creatively	They need staff who think outside the box.
in the pipeline	Something being prepared	I have a project in the pipeline.
in charge of	Having responsibility for	He is in charge of the office.
cutting-edge	The most advanced	Our company uses cutting-edge technology.

Vocabulary List

English Term	Italian Translation
access	accesso
address	indirizzo
airmail	posta aerea
app	applicazione, app
blue-light emissions	emissioni di luce blu
broadband	banda larga
by post	per posta
calculator	calcolatrice
call	chiamata (to)
call back	richiamare
CD (player)	lettore CD
CD-ROM	CD-ROM
chat / chat room	chat / stanza di conversazione
click	cliccare, clic
close down	chiudere
computer	computer
connect	connettere, collegare
connection	connessione, collegamento
copy	copia, copiare
crash	smettere di funzionare
cut	tagliare
delete	eliminare
dial / dial up	comporre (un numero) / connettersi a Internet via linea telefonica
digital	digitale
directory	rubrica, elenco
disk / disc	disco
download	scaricare
drag (the cursor)	trascinare (il cursore)
DVD (player)	lettore DVD
electronic(s)	elettronica
email	e-mail, posta elettronica
engaged	occupato (linea telefonica)